

1941-pattern life vest
The life vest, or "Mae West", was worn over the battledress, and was inflated either orally or by compressed carbon dioxide. The latter was contained in a bottle mounted internally and triggered by a strap on the side of the jacket; the former employed a tube attached to the collar.

Oxygen mask and microphone
The oxygen mask and microphone were separate items that clipped together and fastened to the helmet. The former was needed over 3,000m (10,000ft), at which height a pilot could die from lack of oxygen.

Pistol in holster
Every pilot was issued with an Enfield Mk1 .38 revolver. Its holster was made of canvas.

Floating torch
This wood-and-plastic torch, carried in the life vest, allowed a pilot to draw attention to himself if downed at sea at night.